

4 Formal Logic Cheatsheet

4.1 Propositional Logic

* **Proposition** is a statement which can be either true or false.

Truth-bearer

* **Alphabet** of propositional logic consists of (1) atomic symbols and (2) operator symbols.

* **Atomic formula** (**atom**) is an irreducible formula without logical connectives.

◦ Propositional **variables**: $A, B, C, \dots, Z$. With indices, if needed: $A_1, A_2, \dots, Z_1, Z_2, \dots$

◦ Logical **constants**: $\top$ for always true proposition (*tautology*), $\perp$ for always false proposition (*contradiction*).

* **Logical connectives** (**operators**):

Type	Natural meaning	Symbolization
Negation	It is not the case that $\mathcal{P}$. It is false that $\mathcal{P}$. It is not true that $\mathcal{P}$.	$\neg \mathcal{P}$
Conjunction	Both $\mathcal{P}$ and $\mathcal{Q}$. $\mathcal{P}$ but $\mathcal{Q}$. $\mathcal{P}$, although $\mathcal{Q}$.	$\mathcal{P} \wedge \mathcal{Q}$
Disjunction	Either $\mathcal{P}$ or $\mathcal{Q}$ (or both). $\mathcal{P}$ unless $\mathcal{Q}$.	$\mathcal{P} \vee \mathcal{Q}$
Exclusive or (Xor)	Either $\mathcal{P}$ or $\mathcal{Q}$ (but not both). $\mathcal{P}$ xor $\mathcal{Q}$.	$\mathcal{P} \oplus \mathcal{Q}$
Implication (Conditional)	If $\mathcal{P}$, then $\mathcal{Q}$. $\mathcal{P}$ only if $\mathcal{Q}$. $\mathcal{Q}$ if $\mathcal{P}$.	$\mathcal{P} \rightarrow \mathcal{Q}$
Biconditional	$\mathcal{P}$, if and only if $\mathcal{Q}$. $\mathcal{P}$ iff $\mathcal{Q}$. $\mathcal{P}$ just in case $\mathcal{Q}$.	$\mathcal{P} \leftrightarrow \mathcal{Q}$

* **Sentence** of propositional logic is defined inductively:

Well-formed formula (WFF)

1. Every propositional variable/constant is a sentence.
2. If $\mathcal{A}$ is a sentence, then $\neg \mathcal{A}$ is a sentence.
3. If $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ are sentences, then $(\mathcal{A} \wedge \mathcal{B})$, $(\mathcal{A} \vee \mathcal{B})$, $(\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B})$, $(\mathcal{A} \leftrightarrow \mathcal{B})$ are sentences.
4. Nothing else is a sentence.

* Well-formed formulae grammar:

Backus-Naur form (BNF)

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<sentence> ::= <constant>
              | <variable>
              |  $\neg$  <sentence>
              | '(' <sentence> <binop> <sentence> ')'
<constant> ::=  $\top$  |  $\perp$ 
<variable> ::=  $A$  | ... |  $Z$  |  $A_1$  | ... |  $Z_n$ 
<binop>     ::=  $\wedge$  |  $\vee$  |  $\oplus$  |  $\rightarrow$  |  $\leftarrow$  |  $\leftrightarrow$ 

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* **Literal** is a propositional variable or its negation: $\mathcal{L}_i = X_i$ (*positive literal*), $\mathcal{L}_j = \neg X_j$ (*negative literal*).

* **Argument** is a set of logical statements, called *premises*, intended to support or infer a claim (*conclusion*):

$$\underbrace{\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2, \dots, \mathcal{A}_n}_{\text{premises}} \therefore \underbrace{C}_{\text{conclusion}}$$

“therefore”

* An argument is **valid** if whenever all the premises are true, the conclusion is also true.

Validity

* An argument is **invalid** if there is a case (*a counterexample*) when all the premises are true, but the conclusion is false.

4.2 Semantics of Propositional Logic

- * **Valuation** is any assignment of truth values to propositional variables. Interpretation
- * $\mathcal{A}$ is a **tautology** (valid) iff it is true on *every* valuation. Might be symbolized as “ $\models \mathcal{A}$ ”.
- * $\mathcal{A}$ is a **contradiction** iff it is false on *every* valuation. Might be symbolized as “ $\mathcal{A} \models$ ”.
- * $\mathcal{A}$ is a **contingency** iff it is true on some valuation and false on another. In other words, a **contingent** proposition is neither a tautology nor a contradiction.
- * $\mathcal{A}$ is **satisfiable** iff it is true on *some* valuation. Satisfiability
- * $\mathcal{A}$ is **falsifiable** iff it is not valid, *i.e.* it is false on *some* valuation. Falsifiability
- * $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ are **equivalent** (symbolized as $\mathcal{A} \equiv \mathcal{B}$) iff, for every valuation, their truth values agree, *i.e.* there is no valuation in which they have opposite truth values. Equivalence check
- * $\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2, \dots, \mathcal{A}_n$ are **consistent (jointly satisfiable)** iff there is *some* valuation which makes them all true. Sentences are **inconsistent (jointly unsatisfiable)** iff there is *no* valuation that makes them all true. Consistency
- * The sentences $\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2, \dots, \mathcal{A}_n$ **entail** the sentence C (symbolized as $\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2, \dots, \mathcal{A}_n \models C$) if there is no valuation which makes all of $\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2, \dots, \mathcal{A}_n$ true and C false. Semantic entailment
- * If $\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2, \dots, \mathcal{A}_n \models C$, then the argument $\mathcal{A}_1, \mathcal{A}_2, \dots, \mathcal{A}_n \therefore C$ is **valid**.

Validity check examples:

A	B	$A \rightarrow B$	A	$\therefore$	B	$\neg A \rightarrow \neg B$	$\therefore$	$B \rightarrow A$	$A \rightarrow B$	B	$\therefore$	$\neg(B \rightarrow A)$
0	0	1	0	·	0	1	1	✓	1	0	·	0
0	1	1	0	·	1	1	0	·	0	1	✓	1
1	0	0	1	·	0	0	1	✓	1	0	·	0
1	1	1	1	✓	1	0	1	✓	1	1	✗	0

R	S	T	$R \vee S$	$S \vee T$	$\neg R$	$\therefore$	$S \wedge T$	$(R \wedge S) \rightarrow T$	$\therefore$	$R \rightarrow (S \rightarrow T)$
0	0	0	0	0	1	·	0	0	1	0
0	0	1	0	1	1	·	0	0	1	1
0	1	0	1	1	1	✗	0	0	1	0
0	1	1	1	1	1	✓	1	0	1	1
1	0	0	1	0	0	·	0	0	1	1
1	0	1	1	1	0	·	0	0	1	1
1	1	0	1	1	0	·	0	1	0	0
1	1	1	1	1	0	·	1	1	1	1

- * **Soundness**: $\Gamma \vdash \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \Gamma \models \mathcal{A}$ “Every provable statement is in fact true”
- * **Completeness**: $\Gamma \models \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \Gamma \vdash \mathcal{A}$ “Every true statement has a proof”

4.3 Natural Deduction Rules

Reiteration

m	$\mathcal{A}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A}$	R m

Explosion

m	$\perp$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A}$	X m

Conditional

i	$\mathcal{A}$	
j	$\mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$	$\rightarrow$ I $i-j$

Modus ponens

i	$\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$	
j	$\mathcal{A}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{B}$	MP i, j

Conjunction

i	$\mathcal{A}$	
j	$\mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A} \wedge \mathcal{B}$	$\wedge$ I i, j

m	$\mathcal{A} \wedge \mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A}$	$\wedge$ E m
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{B}$	$\wedge$ E m

Contraposition

m	$\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\neg \mathcal{B} \rightarrow \neg \mathcal{A}$	Contra m

Modus tollens

i	$\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$	
j	$\neg \mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\neg \mathcal{A}$	MT i, j

Biconditional

i	$\mathcal{A}$	
j	$\mathcal{B}$	
k	$\mathcal{B}$	
l	$\mathcal{A}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A} \leftrightarrow \mathcal{B}$	$\leftrightarrow$ I $i-j, k-l$

Negation

i	$\neg \mathcal{A}$	
j	$\mathcal{A}$	
$\therefore$	$\perp$	$\neg$ E i, j

i	$\mathcal{A}$	
j	$\perp$	
$\therefore$	$\neg \mathcal{A}$	$\neg$ I $i-j$

Disjunction

m	$\mathcal{A}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A} \vee \mathcal{B}$	$\vee$ I m

m	$\mathcal{A}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{B} \vee \mathcal{A}$	$\vee$ I m

m	$\mathcal{A} \vee \mathcal{B}$	
i	$\mathcal{A}$	
j	$\mathcal{C}$	
k	$\mathcal{B}$	
l	$\mathcal{C}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{C}$	$\vee$ E $m, i-j, k-l$

i	$\mathcal{A} \leftrightarrow \mathcal{B}$	
j	$\mathcal{A}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{B}$	$\leftrightarrow$ E i, j

i	$\mathcal{A} \leftrightarrow \mathcal{B}$	
j	$\mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A}$	$\leftrightarrow$ E i, j

Indirect proof

i	$\neg \mathcal{A}$	
j	$\perp$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A}$	IP $i-j$

Disjunctive syllogism

i	$\mathcal{A} \vee \mathcal{B}$	
j	$\neg \mathcal{A}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{B}$	DS i, j

i	$\mathcal{A} \vee \mathcal{B}$	
j	$\neg \mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A}$	DS i, j

De Morgan Rules

m	$\neg(\mathcal{A} \vee \mathcal{B})$	
$\therefore$	$\neg \mathcal{A} \wedge \neg \mathcal{B}$	DeM m

m	$\neg \mathcal{A} \wedge \neg \mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\neg(\mathcal{A} \vee \mathcal{B})$	DeM m

m	$\neg(\mathcal{A} \wedge \mathcal{B})$	
$\therefore$	$\neg \mathcal{A} \vee \neg \mathcal{B}$	DeM m

m	$\neg \mathcal{A} \vee \neg \mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\neg(\mathcal{A} \wedge \mathcal{B})$	DeM m

Double negation

m	$\neg \neg \mathcal{A}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A}$	$\neg \neg$ E m

Law of excluded middle

i	$\mathcal{A}$	
j	$\mathcal{B}$	
k	$\neg \mathcal{A}$	
l	$\mathcal{B}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{B}$	LEM $i-j, k-l$

Hypothetical syllogism

i	$\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{B}$	
j	$\mathcal{B} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$	
$\therefore$	$\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$	HS i, j

Green: basic rules.

Orange: derived rules.

More rules can be found in the "forall x: Calgary" book (p. 406).